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Vehicle Immobilization or Impoundment

The agency initiating the immobilizing or impounding action is responsible for vehicle immobilization or impoundment program actions. The following information is provided only for informational purposes. All questions pertaining to vehicle immobilization or impoundment actions are referred to the immobilizing or impounding agency.

A peace officer may cause the immobilization or removal and impoundment of a vehicle when:

- The person driving the vehicle has his or her driving privilege canceled, revoked or the person is not licensed to operate a motor vehicle in any jurisdiction
- The person driving the vehicle is unable to provide proof of Financial Responsibility
- The person driving the vehicle is involved in an accident that results in either property damage or injury or death to another individual
- Law enforcement officer has probable cause to search and either immobilizes or impounds the vehicle

The vehicle shall be immobilized or impounded for a period of 30 days. The vehicle owner, spouse of the owner, or any persons identified on the Vehicle Information Page shall be provided an opportunity for a post storage hearing conducted by the immobilizing impounding agency.

In order for the person's to take possession of the said vehicle proof of current and valid DL and current registration must be provided. The impounding immobilizing agency shall accept a current vehicle registration as proof of ownership.

When a claim has not been made for the return or possession of the vehicle by a person legally entitled to the vehicle within 30 days after a vehicle is immobilized impounded, the person who has possession of the vehicle shall submit an Abandoned Vehicle Report. View the [Abandoned Vehicle Overview](#) and the [Abandoned Vehicle Fees](#) topics for more information.



When the driver of the vehicle at the time of immobilization impoundment is required to install a CIID, the CIID must be installed prior to the release of the vehicle.

The immobilizing impounding agency, storage yard, facility, person or agency having physical possession of the vehicle shall allow access to the immobilized impounded vehicle for the purpose of installing the CIID and shall not charge a fee for providing access for the installation of the CIID.

The owner is responsible for paying all towing, storage and administrative charges related to the immobilization impoundment of the vehicle, unless the vehicle is stolen and the theft was reported to the appropriate law enforcement agency.

Questions pertaining to suspensions may be directed to the Technical Support Unit at (602) 712-4900.

Policies

[3.8.3 Suspensions](#)

[8.1.2 Abandoned Vehicle Reporting / Transfer of Ownership](#)

Forms

[#40-5122 Travel License/Identification Application](#)

[#40-5122s Travel License/Identification Application \(Spanish\)](#)

[#46-4402 Abandoned Vehicle Report](#)

HELPFUL LINKS

» [MVD / DMV Public Website](#) »

» [Customer Portal](#) »

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